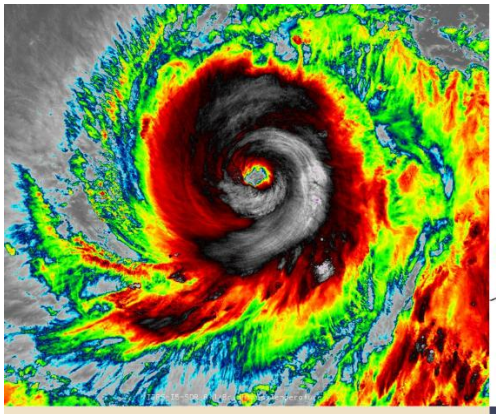
During and After the Typhoon: Safety First and Smart Recovery













Objectives:

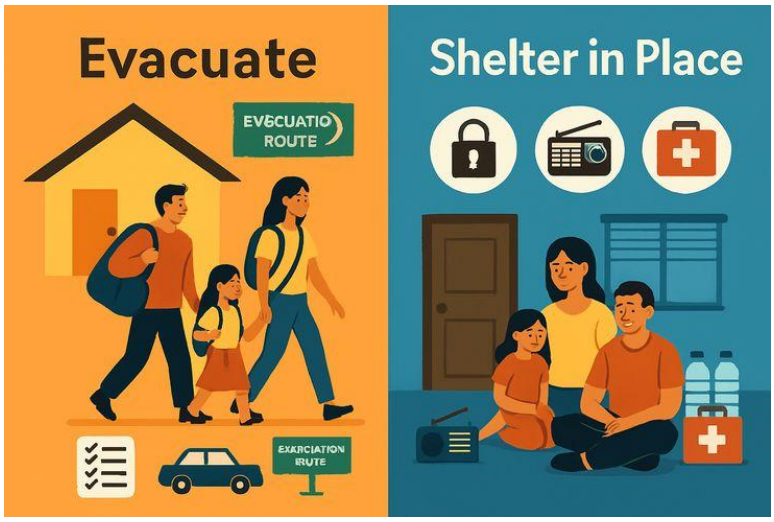
After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- ✧ Practice safety measures during a typhoon.
- ✧ Monitor hazards and respond to emergencies properly.
- ✧ Follow correct procedures when evacuating or sheltering.
- ✧ Apply safety and health precautions after the typhoon.
- ✧ Assist in community recovery and hazard reporting.

During the Typhoon: Safety First

When the typhoon strikes, executing what to do before, during, and after a typhoon shifts to real-time survival. Winds exceeding 120 km/h demand immediate, decisive action:

1. Shelter in Place



✧ Move to a "Safe Zone": Crouch in a windowless interior room or basement. Reinforce doors with heavy furniture. Avoid structures with wide-span roofs (e.g., gyms).

✧ Protect Against Debris: Cover mattresses with thick blankets and press them against windows. Wear helmets (bicycle or construction) and sturdy shoes.

✧ Lighting Safety: Use battery-powered LED lanterns—never candles. Gas leaks from ruptured LPG tanks can ignite explosions.

2. Monitor Threats Relentlessly

✧ Track the Eye: Use your portable power station to keep phones/laptops charged for PAGASA updates via Twitter (@dost_pagasa) or Project NOAH.

✧ Flood Alerts: Set timers to check water levels every 15 minutes. If water rises >5 cm/hour, prepare for vertical evacuation.

3. Cut Utilities Immediately If Flooded

Electricity: Shut off main breakers before water enters outlets—electrocution causes 27% of typhoon deaths in the Philippines.



✧ Gas: Turn off LPG tanks at the valve. Smell for sulfur (rotten egg odor).

4. Evacuate ONLY Under These Conditions

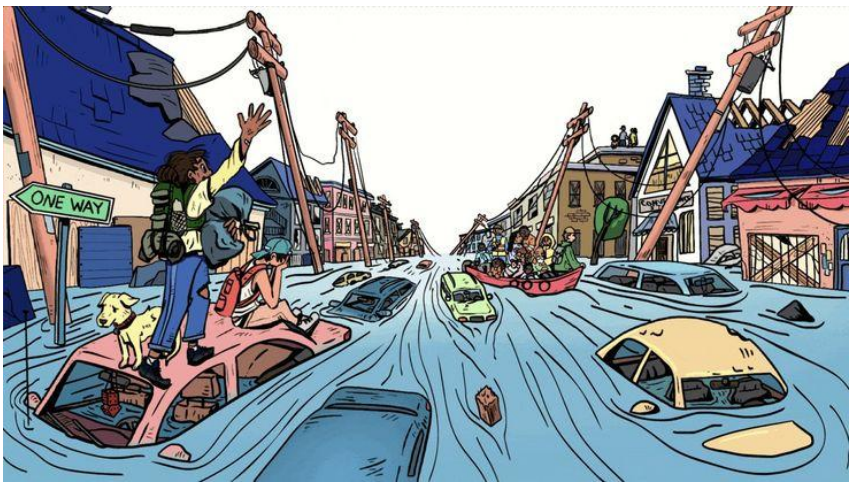


✧ Water reaches knee height indoors within 30 minutes.
✧ Barangay officials broadcast orders via megaphones or SMS.
✧ You see rescue boats (<100 meters away).

Otherwise:

✧ Retreat to the highest point (attic/roof).
✧ Signal rescuers with a flashlight in an SOS pattern (3 short, 3 long, 3 short).

5. Avoid Deadly Hazards



- ✧ **Floodwater**s: Just 15 cm of moving water can sweep adults away. Contaminated water risks leptospirosis—cover cuts with waterproof tape.
- ✧ **Flying Debri**s: Stay 3+ meters from windows. Typhoon Glenda (2014) caused 70% of injuries from shattered glass.

Pro Tip: *Flotation saves lives. Strap empty gallon water jugs to children's life vests. Use doors as rafts if trapped.*

After the Typhoon: Recovery & Caution

What to do after typhoon winds fade demands extreme vigilance—40% of typhoon-related deaths occur during recovery. Follow these critical steps to navigate hazards safely:

1. Wait for Official Clearance

- ✧ Do NOT leave shelter until your Barangay Captain or LGU announces "All Clear" via SMS, social media (@MMDA), or megaphone announcements.
- ✧ **Post-storm threats:** Downed power lines electrify floodwaters (causing 150+ electrocutions yearly). Unstable buildings collapse without warning—like Cebu structures after Typhoon Odette (2021).

2. Conduct a 5-Point Hazard Sweep

Inspect your property systematically:

Risk	Action
Gas leaks	Smell for sulfur; evacuate if detected.
Structural damage	Look for cracks/walls leaning >15°.
Electrical hazards	Assume ALL wires are live; wait for Meralco crews.
Contaminated water	Wear rubber boots and gloves; avoid skin contact.
Displaced animals	Check for snakes/rats in debris piles.

3.Water Safety: Your Health Depends On This
Boil water for 3+ minutes or use WHO-certified tablets (e.g., Potable Aqua).
Flooded wells: Require DOH testing for E. coli and heavy metals.
Emergency sources: Harvest rainwater pre-storm in sanitized drums.

4. Document for Insurance & Aid

- ✧ Photograph damage from multiple angles before cleanup. Zoom in on serial numbers of electronics/appliances.
- ✧ Save flood-soaked items: Insurers need proof for claims (e.g., waterlogged furniture).
- ✧ Register losses at DSWD centers for calamity fund access.

5. Community Recovery Protocol
- ✧ **Check neighbors**: Elderly/disabled residents face the highest post-storm risks.
- ✧ **Report hazards:** Call NDRRMC (911) for blocked roads, broken pipelines, or trapped victims.
- ✧ **Prevent disease**: Spray bleach-water mix (1:10 ratio) on mud lines inside homes to kill bacteria. Burn soaked mattresses/fabrics.

Video Links;

Nine Tips to Follow - Before, During and After Typhoons

https://youtu.be/9KdumJQYwSw?si=7_hU8I-zEl4fcabE

DISASTER WATCH: What to do after a typhoon

https://youtu.be/KaCd5904UqQ?si=8Q75C5Nft5m7rk24

Reference:

EcoFlow

https://www.ecoflow.com/ph/blog/what-to-do-before-during-and-after-a-typhoon